justice. I wanted to discover how computer science could influence the ethics of the modern world. That was my plan, and I rebuilt myself for the purpose. In the meantime, Nortel and other victims of my so-called hacking crimes began using the cryptography software I'd invented during my late-night walks through their system.

No victory comes without a shadow of defeat. And some decades of your life, weirdly, can come out of the wash looking defeated. Some people say that being young is a victory in itself, but I doubt that. I was tired and nervous in my twenties in a way that I never am now. What I might observe is the strain of trying to push things forward. There's an invitation in front of me to a party we threw in North Melbourne at Easter, 1996, organised by the group of us involved in setting up that early ISP, suburbia.net. Just looking at the invitation gives me an indication of who I was at the time. I was excitable and committed, but no doubt overbearing and a pain in the arse. Having set out the logistics of the party on the invitation, there follows a little questionnaire.

> *Q: who's invited?*
> *A: you. A cross-social strata of individuals, occupations and ages. It will be an eclectic evening.*
> *Q: no, I mean who will really be there?*
> *A: now is not the time for potentially dichotomatic simplifications of character, but what the heck . . .*

> • *Suburbia users:*
> *From magistrates and politicians to convicted computer hackers. We have as users private investigators, writers, programmers, QCs, record producers, musicians, film directors, journalists, policemen, intelligence agents, chess champions, members of obscure religious sects, netball umpires, many, many types of scientists and engineers, security experts, doctors, accountants, bartenders, choral conductors . . .*

I hope you like netball umpires. I'm not sure what their role was intended to be in the coming revolution. Anyhow, the 'invitation' goes on to suggest